



Serving their country

Young men from western Pennsylvania are sworn in to the Army after being drafted for military service in 1967. Scenes like this were commonplace during the war years.

The draft lottery

As a result of the public discontent, Congress passed legislation in 1970, authorizing a lottery system to make draft selection fairer. Young men watched with bated breath as Selective Service officials drew tiles—366 of them, one for each day of the year—from a hopper on national television. Eligible men with birthdays drawn in the first third or so of the process received induction notices, while those whose birthdays were drawn last did not. The process was more rational, but hardly felt fair to those who were called up and did not want to go to Vietnam.